The Strategy of Uniqueness

Differentiation, Identity & Storytelling

Challenges of Sameness

- Overcrowded markets
- Interchangeable experiences
- Attention scarcity

Differentiation

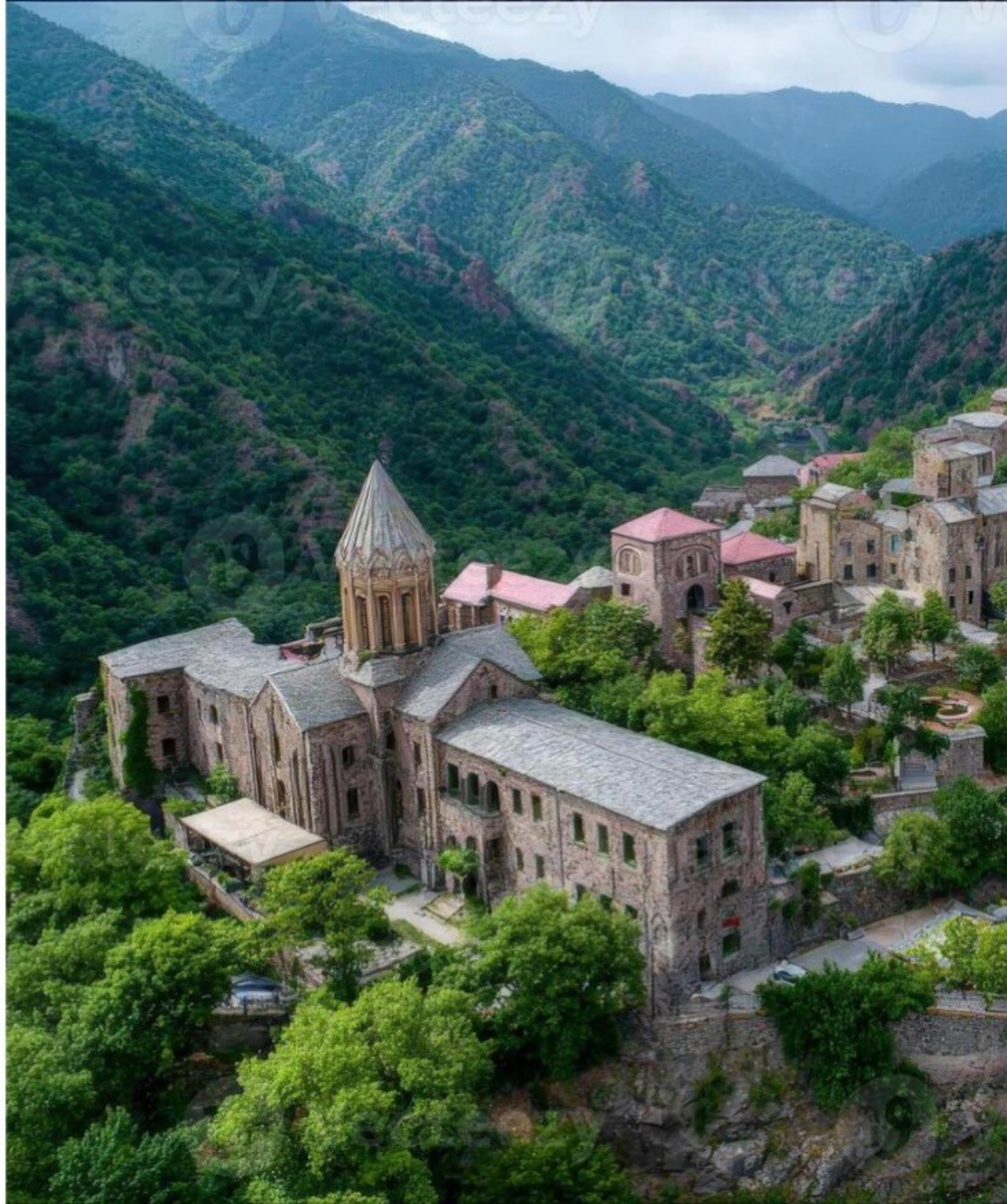
- Meaning, not features
- Emotional value
- Symbolic meaning

Competitive Identity

- Anholt's Hexagon
- Reputation as a national asset

Identity vs Image

- Identity –
  what the place *is*,
  can be complex
- Image –
  how it is *perceived*,
  can be simplified



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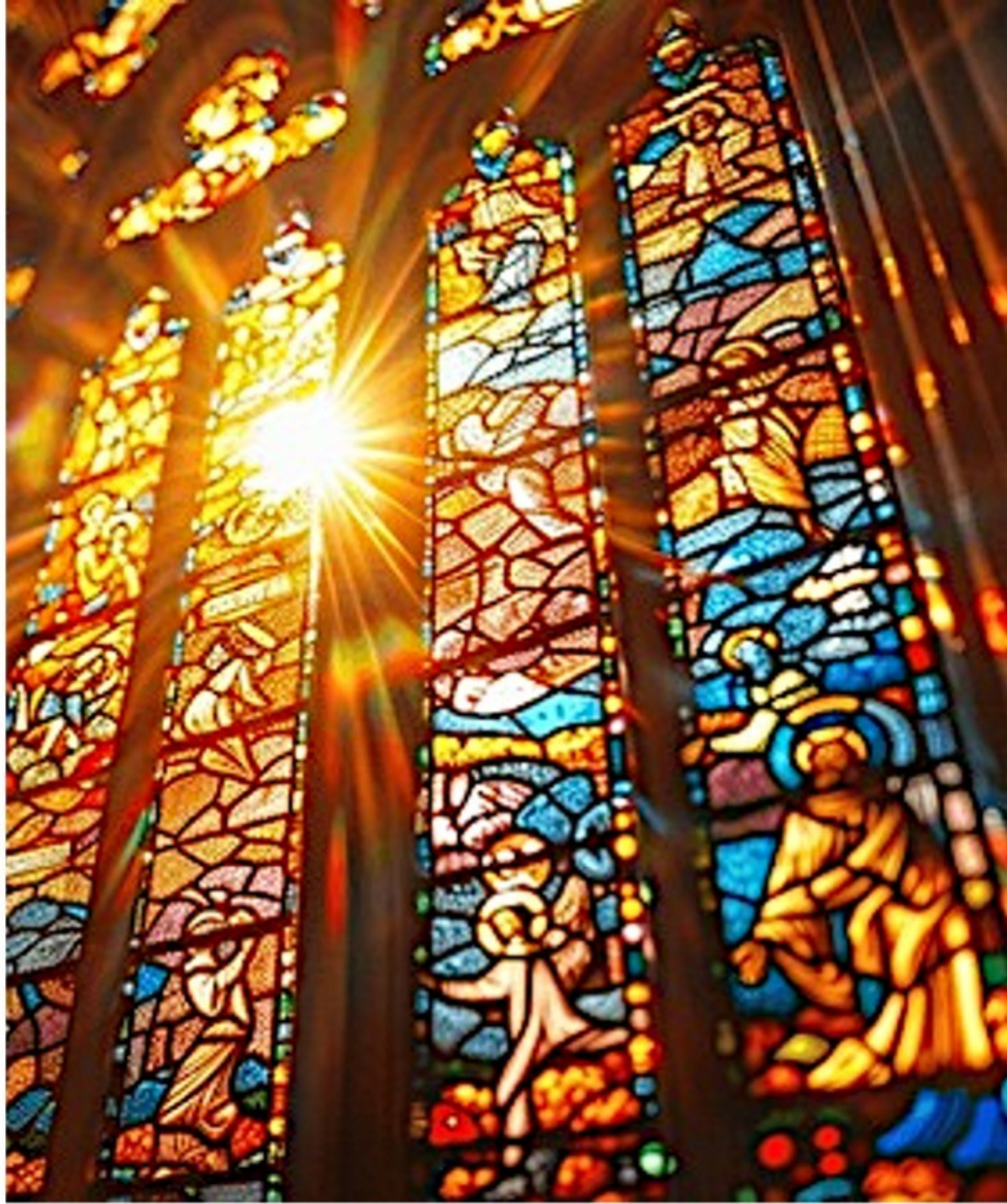


Authenticity

- Objective
- Constructive
- Existential
- Who decides?

Sense of Place

- Emotional Geography
- Belonging
- Everyday life
  as an asset

Cultural Assets

- Tangible – Heritage, cuisine, festivals
- Intangible – Values, humour, rituals

Storytelling

- Destinations understood through narrative
- Create emotional coherence
- Strategic approach

Narrative Structure

- Hero
- Conflict
- Transformation

Finland

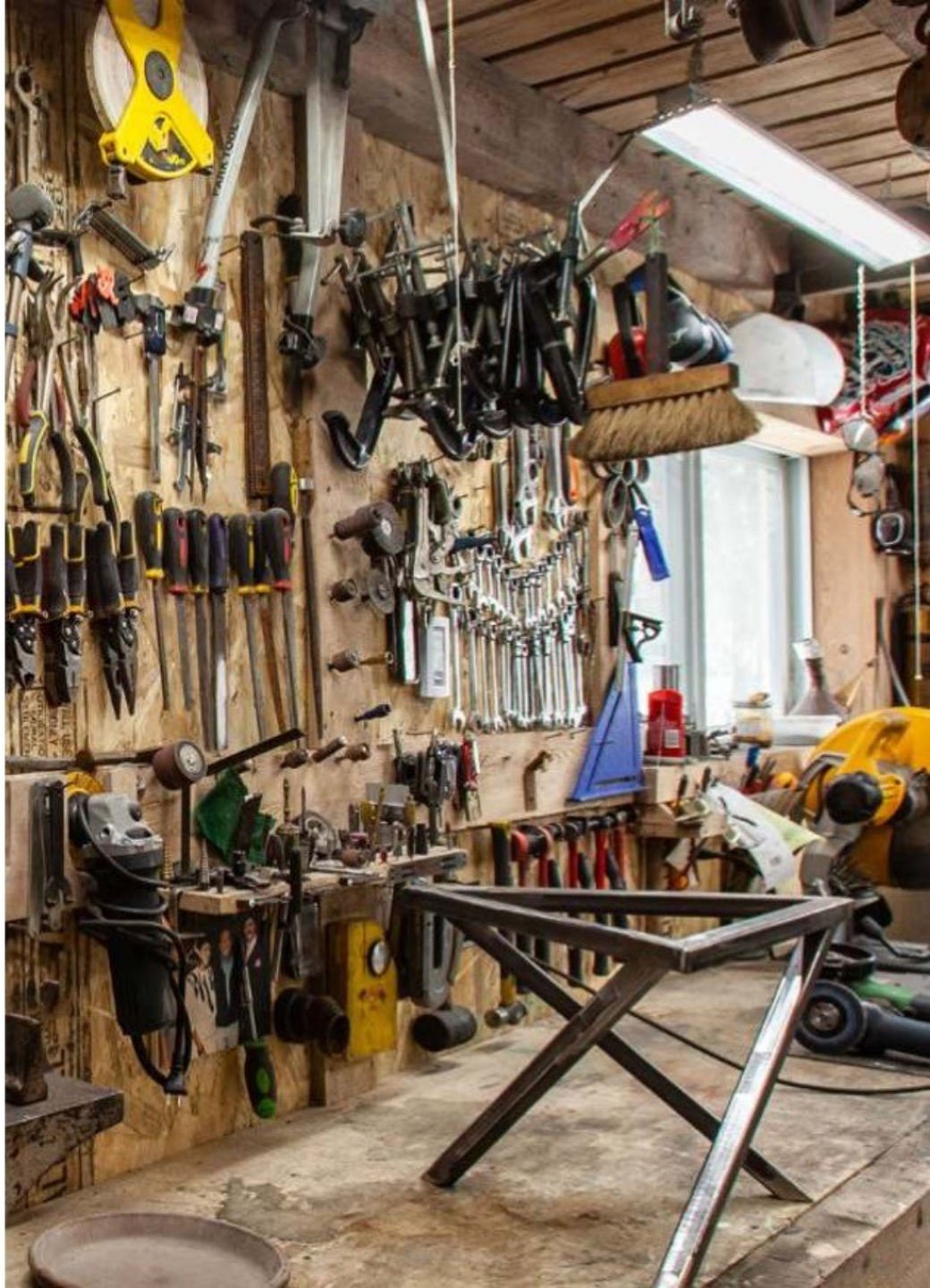
- Identity – Quiet, nature-connected, introspective
- Narrative – Happiness through simplicity

Peru

- Identity –
  Cultural richness
- Narrative –
  Richness re-defined

Workshop

- Identity –
  This is a place where…
- Emotion –
  Visitors feel…
- Promise –
  You leave with…



Takeaways

- Uniqueness is revealed, not invented
- Identity must be lived, not performed
- Storytelling is the Bridge between Place & Perception